



Supercomputer running on light
Jean Zay supercomputer is now the first HPC to use light to transmit and process information.
<https://digit.in/jan22-11>



No more BlackBerryOS support
As of January 4, BlackBerry has pulled support for BlackBerryOS phones.
<https://digit.in/jan22-12>

Acer Boundless 50-inch 4K LED Smart TV

Lost in the crowd



Price
₹32,999

In our experience, the 50-inch TV space has a very specific audience. It's for those that feel a 43-inch TV is too small while a 55-inch TV is too big for their entertainment setup. We have 50-inch TVs from Redmi, AmazonBasics, TCL and more trying to fill the void. Today we have the Acer 50-inch Boundless TV with us for review. Is it a good option to consider, let's find out?



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DLED backlighting and no dimming zones. In our tests, we found the TV has a peak brightness slightly above 300-nits, which isn't impressive.

An interesting thing to note is that in the movie preset the 2pt greyscale delta error is quite low but the RGB balance for this is all over the place. In the ColorChecker Analysis, the average Delta error is quite high in the movie preset and that translates to real-world performance as well.

BUILD AND DESIGN

The TV has 2 plastic feet that hold it in place. It has a plastic shell and relatively slim bezels on three sides. For connectivity, the TV has three HDMI ports, two USB ports, optical out, ethernet port, antenna port, 3.5mm audio and an AV in port. The port may not be easy to reach when the TV is wall mounted so cable management is something to consider in advance.

The remote control that comes with the TV has a slightly concave design giving it a good grip.

DISPLAY PANEL QUALITY

The Acer 50-inch Boundless TV has

PERFORMANCE

Starting with the 4K and HDR performance, the TV does not support Dolby Vision so our suite of content from Netflix, Apple TV and more played back in HDR 10. The performance from HDR 10 lacked the punch one would expect from the movie preset. Switching to the Standard or Dynamic preset punched up the colours, and the backlighting but changed the colour temperature to show a slightly cooler bias. This can easily be fixed by changing the colour temperature to Warm.

All the content we consumed in HDR looked decent enough except for content like The Dark Knight Rises and

Altered Carbon, where the details in a lot of the dark sequences were lost.

When it comes to SDR content, the TV can do a good job of representing it. Put simply, use the Movie preset for movies as it does a decent job of representing the colours well. In some SDR content like Young Sheldon and other TV shows, the Standard preset with a neutral colour temperature does a better job. So, if you watch the news and everyday TV shows, then the Standard preset works better.

The Acer Boundless TV does not have a dedicated game mode in the picture settings, but the TV recognised when a PS5 was connected to it. In a game like Spider-Man Miles Morales, you miss the punchy highlights found on slightly more expensive TVs, but the experience isn't bad on this TV. However, it has weak contrast. The TV may not be ideal for gaming, but gets the job done for casual gamers.

If there is one place the TV suffers, it is with the sound output. However, for everyday activities like news and TV shows, you should be fine.

VERDICT

The Acer Boundless 50-inch TV does little to transcend the boundaries of the budget TV segment. It is yet another budget TV with good SDR performance, average HDR output and a decent smart TV experience. The audio output is acceptable for everyday content and the gaming experience is decent as well on the Acer Boundless TV. But then again, the overall experience is slightly better on the Redmi TV 50-inch which is slightly more expensive than the Acer.

—Sameer Mitha

SPECIFICATIONS

PANEL SIZE: 50-inch (available in 43 and 55-inch screen sizes) | PANEL TYPE: VA with D-LED backlighting | PANEL RESOLUTION: 3840 x 2160 - 4K | PANEL REFRESH RATE: 60Hz | HDR 10 SUPPORT: Yes | HDR 10+ SUPPORT: Yes | DOLBY VISION SUPPORT: No | WEIGHT: 9.9 kgs | HDMI PORTS: 3 | USB PORTS: 2 | BLUETOOTH: Yes | WI-FI: Yes | ETHERNET: Yes | SPEAKERS: 24W | BUILT-IN STORAGE: 16GB

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